

Word, there may be someone who wants to do both of them and a little bit of systems and web programming, some animation, a little server stuff and more. Lists are endless for the demands and there are software for which its manufacturers cry out loud “my product can do everything”. Well, while having a lot is never bad if you need it all, it can certainly be bad if it turns out to be like the birthday gift you never wanted. You’ll probably lose your mind trying to figure out what to do with it and go mental in the process. That’s what extra features can do. They can cause instability, bloat your memory and slow down your system while running. We’ll tell you the different features general virtualization software would / should have and the uses of those features. This will help you make decisions later on. What kind of decisions? Let’s say you want to run multiple virtual machines at a time to learn networking and want virtualization software which is stable, consumes less memory and has different networking features for virtual machines. In such a case, you’re not really in need of software which supports 3D effects and bloats your system unnecessarily.

Ability to take advantage of hardware features

In Chapter 2, we’ve already spoken about hardware features which assist in virtualization. One of them was the processor, which needs to have virtualization support. In the current line of processors, that means Intel VT-x and AMD-V. If the processor allows you to do things at a faster rate with more reliability and the software can’t take advantage of it, then the fault is of the software.

Good virtualization software takes advantages of such hardware features. As a matter of fact, most popular ones do. Buy or download one that doesn’t blow a hole in your pocket. Oh, and yes, in case you don’t go in for Intel VT-X or AMD-V, you must also know whether your processor features those technologies or not. If your software supports them and the processor doesn’t, it’s once again a bad deal. In most cases, a software which supports virtualization features built into the modern processors would run on one which doesn’t but there are exceptions. The biggest and most famous known such exception is the “XEN Hypervisor” – it doesn’t work unless you have a processor featuring virtualization assistive technologies.

So yeah, make sure that your hardware and software both have support for it. If you have the hardware support, go for software which utilises it. It’s a win-win situation.